

FREIGHT

Load of materials or products carried on trains. The term is also used to describe trains transporting finished goods and raw materials.

GAUGE

Distance between the inside running edges of the rails of a track.

GENERATOR

An electromechanical device that converts mechanical energy to electrical energy in the form of direct current (DC).

GRADIENT

The slope of a track. It is expressed in ratio form in terms of the height covered per unit of horizontal distance.

INJECTOR

Device that feeds water into the boiler of a steam locomotive against the pressure of steam in that boiler.

LIGHT RAIL

Form of rail that typically operates within urban environments or in low density non-urban areas.

LOCOMOTIVE

A wheeled vehicle used for pulling trains. Steam and diesel locomotives generate their own power, while electric locomotives collect electricity from an external source.

LOOP

A railway formation where tracks cross over themselves as they ascend a mountain.

MAIL TRAINS

Earmarked for carrying mail in addition to passengers, mail trains have special mail vans attached. Historically, these were accorded higher